

OPERATIONS EXPENSES

Website Service Expense Guide

This document explains the three live services required to keep the Bestworth website available, secure, and functional after handover.

Purpose

The website depends on three paid cloud services. Each service covers a different responsibility. If one is not maintained, a part of the website will stop working.

- Render hosts the website and backend API.
- MongoDB Atlas stores products, leadership records, inquiries, CMS content, and supporting data.
- SendGrid delivers inquiry alerts, confirmation emails, and admin replies.

Service Overview

Service	What It Covers	If Not Maintained
Render	Production hosting, API uptime, environment variables, public deployment	Website or admin area may go offline
MongoDB Atlas	Database storage for live content, inquiries, leadership, products, and settings	Content and data access may fail
SendGrid	Outgoing email for new inquiries, user confirmations, and admin replies	Inquiry emails and replies may stop sending

Billing and Subscription Links

- Render billing and plan management: <https://dashboard.render.com/web/srv-d8o1sh8g4nts73c6llog/plan>
- SendGrid billing and plan selection: https://app.sendgrid.com/account/billing/choose_plan
- MongoDB Atlas billing overview:
<https://cloud.mongodb.com/v2#/org/6a3019c22654b504044929f1/billing/overview>

How To Manage Each Service

1. Render

- Use Render to keep the live website deployed and reachable on the public domain.
- Review service health, instance type, restart history, and environment variables here.
- When billing is interrupted, the production site may suspend or fail to start.

2. MongoDB Atlas

- Use Atlas to monitor storage, backups, connection health, and cluster billing.
- This database holds the live CMS content, products, leadership data, and inquiries.

- If the database is unavailable, the website can load but content and admin functions may return service errors.

3. SendGrid

- Use SendGrid to keep transactional email delivery active.
- This includes inquiry notifications to the company, customer confirmation emails, and replies from admin.
- If SendGrid is not maintained, inquiries can still save to the database, but email delivery may fail.

Why These Costs Matter

- Hosting cost keeps the site publicly reachable.
- Database cost keeps live content and operational records available.
- Email cost keeps communication professional and automatic.

Monthly Maintenance Checklist

- Confirm Render billing is active and the service status is healthy.
- Confirm MongoDB Atlas billing is active and storage usage is within plan limits.
- Confirm SendGrid billing is active and email sending is still accepted.
- Send one test inquiry from the public site and confirm the company receives the notification.
- Sign into the admin panel and confirm products, leadership, and CMS content still load.

Ownership Recommendations

- Use a company-owned billing card or managed finance process for all three services.
- Keep more than one authorized company contact on each platform where possible.
- Store platform recovery details, invoice emails, and support contacts in the handover file.
- Review usage every month and re-evaluate plan size only when traffic, storage, or email volume increases.

Decision Guidance

The safest approach is to keep all three services active at all times. Render covers availability, MongoDB Atlas covers data continuity, and SendGrid covers professional communication. Removing any one of them reduces the reliability of the full system.